

GroomBook: booking requests for Kevin's Mobile Dog Grooming

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Live app: groombook-eta.vercel.app **Code:** github.com/ErikEllis-git/groombook

The problem

"Clients text me to book, and I lose track of it all... I just want it to stop being chaotic."

Bookings arrive as free-form texts mixed in with everything else on his phone. Details are missing (which dog? where? what service?), nothing records whether a request was answered, and the only "system" is memory. He needs every request in one place, complete, and impossible to miss.

What I built: one thing for each of Kevin's asks

"People can request an appointment"

A booking page

A one-minute, phone-friendly form that collects what a mobile groomer needs: dog, size, service, address, preferred day and time, and notes like gate codes.

"See all the requests in one place"

One dashboard

Every request sorted into **New** → **Upcoming** → **Completed**. Kevin confirms a time, declines, or marks a job done. Upcoming jobs are grouped by day.

"Get notified when a new one comes in"

Instant phone alerts

His phone buzzes seconds after a request arrives, showing the dog, service and day. One tap opens the dashboard, where the contact details stay private.

How Kevin's day changes

1. A customer taps Kevin's booking link and sends a request.
2. Kevin's phone buzzes with a summary, so there's no digging through texts.
3. He opens the dashboard, picks a time and taps **Confirm**.
4. **Text confirmation** opens his messaging app with the reply prewritten.
5. After the groom: **Mark completed**.

Why this solves it

- **Nothing gets lost:** every request has a status, so nothing sits forgotten in a text thread.
- **Complete info every time:** no back-and-forth texting for details.
- **No new habits:** it runs on his phone, and he still texts customers himself.
- **\$0/month to run as an MVP**, with no app for customers to install.

Under the hood & next steps

Next.js 16 + TypeScript, Postgres (Neon) with Drizzle ORM, Zod validation, password-protected dashboard, spam and duplicate protection, ntfy push alerts, deployed on Vercel. Unit and end-to-end tests run in CI. **Next:** automatic reminder texts (Twilio), customer and pet history for repeat clients, and a calendar with days off blocked out. For production, hosting moves to a commercial plan (~\$20/mo).

